Name: **Roll No:** **Batch:**

Pre-reading - Think about the following questions.

1. What does your name mean?
2. Who chose your name? Is there a story behind it?
3. How important is your name to your identity?
4. If you could change your name, would you? Why or why not?

During Reading - As you read, make notes to engage with the text.

- Underline words or sentences that seem important.
- Circle unfamiliar words.
- Mark any sentence that surprises you, makes you think or raises a question.

My Name - Excerpt from *The House on Mango Street* (1984) by Sandra Cisneros

In English my name means hope. In Spanish it means too many letters. It means sadness, it means waiting. It is like the number nine. A muddy color. It is the Mexican records my father plays on Sunday mornings when he is shaving, songs like sobbing.

It was my great-grandmother's name and now it is mine. She was a horse woman too, born like me in the Chinese year of the horse-which is supposed to be bad luck if you're born female-but I think this is a Chinese lie because the Chinese, like the Mexicans, don't like their women strong. My great-grandmother. I would've liked to have known her, a wild horse of a woman, so wild she wouldn't marry. Until my great-grandfather threw a sack over her head and carried her off. Just like that, as if she were a fancy chandelier. That's the way he did it.

And the story goes she never forgave him. She looked out the window her whole life, the way so many women sit their sadness on an elbow. I wonder if she made the best with what she got or was she sorry because she couldn't be all the things she wanted to be. Esperanza. I have inherited her name, but I don't want to inherit her place by the window.

At school they say my name funny as if the syllables were made out of tin and hurt the roof of your mouth. But in Spanish my name is made out of a softer something, like silver, not quite as thick as sister's name-Magdalena-which is uglier than mine. Magdalena who at least can come home and become Nenny. But I am always Esperanza.

I would like to baptize myself under a new name, a name more like the real me, the one nobody sees. Esperanza as Lisandra or Maritza or Zeze the X. Yes. Something like Zeze the X will do.

After Reading

Part I: Finding the main idea - Choose the statement that best expresses the central idea of the passage.

___ The author explores how her name connects her to family history, culture, gender and her search for a personal identity.

___ The author argues that people should be free to choose their own names because names influence how others perceive them.

___ The passage shows how cultural traditions often shape the lives and identities of women across generations.

___ The author reflects on her childhood experiences to explain why she feels disconnected from her cultural heritage.

Explain your answer using evidence from the passage.

_____

_____

Part II: Reading between the lines - Critical reading involves considering ideas that are implied rather than directly stated.

Answer the following questions.

1. What does the window symbolize in the story?

_____

_____

_____

2. Why does Esperanza describe her great-grandmother as "a wild horse of a woman"?

_____

_____

_____

3. Why do you think the passage ends with Esperanza imagining a different name?

_____

_____

_____

Part III: Reading Critically

There may be more than one possible answer. Support your ideas with evidence from the text.

1. What does this passage suggest about the relationship between identity and family?

_____

_____

_____

2. What does it suggest about the expectations placed on women?

_____

_____

_____

_____

3. Is changing one's name enough to change one's identity? Why or why not?

Part IV: Personal Response - Write a short response in about 80–100 words.

Do you think a person's name shapes their identity, or is identity created through experiences and choices? You may use ideas from *My Name* to support your response.